LEADER SELF-AWARENESS

Facilitator's Guide

DESCRIPTION	Utilize this facilitator's guide for: • Leader Self-Awareness Video • The Power of Everyday Reflection Resource Sheet • Addressing Imposter Syndrome Resource Sheet
OBJECTIVES	Participants should be able to: • Apply Borton's Reflective Model to improve decision-making and team dynamics. • Analyze imposter syndrome's impact on leadership and develop confidence-building strategies. • Identify personal leadership strengths and weaknesses to enhance self-awareness and effectiveness. • Demonstrate strategies to reframe negative self-talk and overcome imposter syndrome.
Time for Facilitation	Between 20 - 120 minutes

Introduction

Brief Starting Intro:

Leadership begins from within, and self-awareness is the foundation of effective leadership. Without it, leaders struggle to understand their strengths, weaknesses, and impact on others. Through intentional reflection, leaders can gain deeper insight into their decisions, behaviors, and emotional triggers, allowing them to lead with authenticity and adaptability. However, many high-achieving leaders also grapple with imposter syndrome, doubting their abilities despite clear evidence of their success. Left unchecked, this self-doubt can undermine confidence, decision-making, and team trust. By developing self-awareness through reflection and addressing imposter syndrome, leaders cultivate resilience, build credibility, and create environments where both they and their teams can thrive.

Pre-Facilitation: Check with participants to see if they watched the video and read the resource articles. They should have both watched and read the resources prior to asking the

following questions.

Best Practice Facilitation: Place participants into pairs of two so that they can share first with the other participant before sharing their answer with the whole group. This “pair and share” technique allows individuals to test out their answer(s) with someone else first (instilling confidence in the answer) and helps to start building stronger relationships with others in the program.

Depending on the time you have, select the questions that work within your schedule for training. Since we are utilizing the “pair and share” method, you should provide the participants with 2 minutes each to discuss their answers (let them know when to switch to keep them on time). Then have those who want to share their answers with the whole group a chance to do so (select 2 or 3 people to share - do not force participation). This can take up to 5 minutes. In total the pair and share technique for each question will take approximately 10 minutes. If you do not use the pair and share, allow 5-7 minutes for individuals to respond to the who group.

Leader Self-Awareness General Questions

The following questions are based on the video:

1. What does self-awareness mean to you as a leader, how does your self-awareness (or lack of it) impact the people you lead, and can you share a specific instance where being self-aware helped or hindered your leadership?
2. How do you currently practice self-reflection in your leadership role, what tools or methods have you found effective for reflecting on your actions and decisions, and how could you create more space in your daily routine for intentional reflection?
3. How comfortable are you with acknowledging your strengths and weaknesses, how does being honest about your weaknesses enhance your credibility as a leader, and what steps can you take to leverage your strengths while addressing areas for improvement?
4. How do you think imposter syndrome might affect your leadership, have you ever experienced moments of self-doubt and how did you overcome them, and how can acknowledging imposter syndrome help you connect more authentically with your team?
5. How do you foster self-awareness in others on your team, what strategies could you use to encourage your team members to reflect on their performance, and how might improving the self-awareness of your team members impact their performance and engagement?
6. How do you respond to feedback and what does it reveal about your self-awareness, can you recall a time when feedback shifted your perspective or behavior as a leader, and how can you create a culture where feedback is seen as a tool for growth rather than criticism?

Additional Activity on Leader Self-Awareness:

1. Self-Assessment: Begin the workshop by providing participants with the *General Leader Self-Awareness* questionnaire provided. Encourage them to reflect on their current self-awareness habits, strengths, and areas for improvement. Ask participants to rate their effectiveness in key areas such as emotional self-awareness, accurate self-assessment, and self-confidence.
2. Group Discussion: Facilitate a group discussion where participants share their self-assessment results and insights. Encourage open dialogue about common challenges and best practices for dealing with self-awareness. Guide participants to identify common themes and patterns in their self-awareness habits.

The Power of Everyday Reflection Questions

The following questions are based on *The Power of Everyday Reflection* Article:

1. How might regularly asking "What? So What? Now What?" transform your approach to setbacks or failures? What types of situations in your leadership could benefit most from this model, and how could you incorporate it into your daily routine?
2. How do you currently reflect on the impact your actions have on your team? What new strategies could you use to better understand your team members' perspectives, and how might this improve team dynamics?
3. In the article, it's mentioned that self-reflection helps leaders uncover blind spots. How do you currently identify your blind spots, and what steps can you take to ensure you address them effectively?
4. The article emphasizes turning failure into a catalyst for success through reflection. Can you share a time when you used reflection to grow from a mistake? What did you learn, and how could you apply those lessons in future situations?
5. The article describes how self-reflection sharpens decision-making and problem-solving skills. How do you currently approach critical decisions, and how might incorporating regular reflection enhance your strategic thinking?
6. How can you foster a culture of reflection within your team or organization? What steps can you take to encourage your team to use reflection for their growth, and how might this impact overall team performance and morale?

Additional Everday Reflection Activity: **Reflection Role Play - Building Awareness Through Perspective-Taking**

Objective: To deepen participants' understanding of how their actions and decisions impact others by practicing self-reflection through perspective-taking, guided by Borton's Reflective Model.

Purpose:

- Help leaders develop empathy and self-awareness by reflecting on their behavior and decisions from the perspective of others.

- Encourage participants to use structured reflection to identify strengths, weaknesses, and actionable insights.
- Highlight the impact of leadership actions on team dynamics and organizational outcomes.

Materials Needed: Scenarios and role cards with different team member perspectives (*Both provided at the end of the facilitation guide*)

Instructions:

1. **Introduction:**
   - Explain the importance of reflection in leadership, especially in understanding how decisions and actions influence others.
   - Briefly introduce Borton's Reflective Model ("What? So What? Now What?") and explain how it will guide the activity.
2. **Scenario Setup:**
   - Present a leadership scenario for participants to reflect on. Two Scenarios are provided at the end of this facilitation guide. Additional examples could include:
     - A challenging team meeting with conflict.
     - A missed project deadline due to poor communication.
     - Alternatively, participants can choose a real leadership situation they've experienced.
3. **Assign Roles:**
   - Divide participants into groups of 4-5 and assign each person a role. Both the scenarios and corresponding roles are provided at the end of this facilitation guide. Roles can include in other situations:
     - The leader (their own perspective).
     - A direct report.
     - A peer or collaborator.
     - A senior leader or stakeholder.
     - A customer or client.
   - Provide each participant with a role card describing their perspective in the scenario.
4. **Role Play and Reflection:**
   - Ask the leader in each group to briefly describe the situation from their perspective using the **"What?"** stage of Borton's Model (What happened?).
     - Group members reflect on how they (in their assigned roles) perceived the leader's actions and decisions.
   - Use the **"So What?"** stage to explore:
     - How did the leader's actions make you feel?
     - What was the impact of their decisions on you?
     - What did this reveal about their strengths or weaknesses?
   - Return to the leader, who reflects on what they've learned from hearing these perspectives. Transition to the **"Now What?"** stage:
     - What will you do differently to improve outcomes in the future?
     - How can you better consider other perspectives in similar situations?
5. **Group Discussion and Debrief (15 minutes):**
   - Bring everyone back together and ask each group to share their key takeaways.

- Debrief with the following questions:
  - *What surprised you about hearing different perspectives?*
  - *How might this change the way you approach reflection and decision-making?*
  - *What strategies will you use to better understand how your leadership impacts others?*

6. **Outcome:**
   This exercise helps participants see their leadership through the eyes of others, fostering empathy, self-awareness, and a commitment to continuous improvement. Leaders will leave with actionable insights to enhance their leadership effectiveness.

Addressing Imposter Syndrome Questions

The following questions are based on the Addressing Imposter Syndrome Article:

1. How has imposter syndrome affected your leadership effectiveness in the past? When have you experienced self-doubt about your leadership abilities, what triggered those feelings, and how did those feelings influence your decision-making or interactions with your team?
2. Which type of imposter syndrome described in the article resonates most with you, and why? How do the characteristics of this type show up in your day-to-day leadership practices, and what steps can you take to challenge the thought patterns associated with this type?
3. What role does perfectionism play in how you approach leadership? How have unattainable standards impacted your ability to delegate or trust your team, and what changes could you make to balance high standards with self-compassion?
4. How do workplace pressures or societal expectations contribute to your feelings of inadequacy? Have there been moments where external comparisons or biases amplified your imposter feelings, and what strategies could you implement to reframe these pressures and focus on your unique leadership value?
5. How can adopting a growth mindset help you overcome imposter syndrome in your leadership? Can you identify a situation where viewing a mistake as a learning opportunity improved your confidence, and how can you use a growth mindset to encourage resilience in your team?
6. What support systems do you have in place to address self-doubt? How has feedback from peers, mentors, or your team helped you recognize your strengths, and what steps can you take to build stronger relationships that foster support and encouragement?
7. How do you currently celebrate your successes? What prevents you from fully acknowledging your achievements, and how can celebrating milestones—both big and small—reinforce your confidence as a leader?

Additional Addressing Imposter Syndrome Activity:

Objective: To help leaders recognize imposter syndrome in themselves, understand how it affects their leadership, and develop strategies to overcome it using self-reflection and peer support.

Purpose:

- Encourage self-awareness about imposter syndrome and its impact on leadership effectiveness.
- Identify personal triggers and thought patterns that contribute to imposter syndrome.
- Provide a safe space for participants to share experiences and reframe negative self-perceptions.
- Develop actionable strategies to counter imposter syndrome and lead with confidence.

Materials Needed:

- Flipcharts or whiteboards with markers.

Instructions:

Step 1: Icebreaker – "Recognizing the Imposter"

1. Ask participants to anonymously write down one self-doubt they have experienced as a leader on a piece of paper.
2. Collect the responses and read a few aloud (without identifying the writer).
3. Ask the group:
   - *How many of these statements sound familiar?*
   - *Why do we struggle to acknowledge our own competence despite evidence of success?*

Step 2: Identifying Your Imposter Type

1. Refer to the article and the five types of imposter syndrome (Perfectionist, Superwoman/Superman, Natural Genius, Soloist, Expert).
2. Ask participants to self-identify which type they relate to most.
3. In small groups, have them discuss:
   - *How does this type of imposter syndrome show up in your leadership?*
   - *What impact has it had on your decision-making, delegation, or confidence?*
4. Have each group share a key takeaway with the larger group.

Step 3: Reframing Imposter Thoughts

1. On a flipchart, write common imposter syndrome thoughts, such as:
   - "I was just lucky to get this role."
   - "I don't deserve this success."
   - "Soon they'll realize I'm not as competent as they think."
2. Ask participants to rewrite these statements using a growth mindset approach:
   - Example: "I was just lucky to get this role" → "I earned this role through my experience, skills, and hard work."
3. Participants should then write down one imposter thought they have personally experienced and rewrite it in a way that fosters confidence.

Step 4: Developing Confidence and Support Systems

1. Ask participants to think about who in their professional lives supports them (mentors, peers, colleagues).
2. In pairs, discuss:
   - *How have these people helped you see your strengths?*
   - *How can you seek more feedback and support to challenge imposter thoughts?*

Step 5: Commitment to Action

1. Each participant writes down one specific action they will take to combat imposter syndrome in the next 30 days.
2. Ask for a few volunteers to share their commitments with the group.
3. Close with a discussion on:
   - *How can leaders create a culture where imposter syndrome is acknowledged and addressed?*
   - *How can organizations foster confidence and growth rather than fear of failure?*

Facilitator Tips:

- Normalize imposter syndrome by sharing real-life examples of accomplished leaders who have experienced it.
- Create a supportive environment where participants feel safe sharing their struggles.
- Reinforce that overcoming imposter syndrome is a journey, not an overnight fix.

General Leader Self-Awareness Assessment

Instructions: Please rate each statement on a scale of 1 to 5, where 1 indicates "Strongly Disagree" and 5 indicates "Strongly Agree."

1. I regularly reflect on my decisions and actions to evaluate their impact.

1 2 3 4 5

2. I understand how my emotions influence my behavior in leadership situations.

1 2 3 4 5

3. I am aware of my personal strengths and how they contribute to my leadership effectiveness.

1 2 3 4 5

4. I acknowledge and work on my weaknesses to improve my leadership skills.

1 2 3 4 5

5. I seek feedback from others to gain insight into how I am perceived as a leader.

1 2 3 4 5

6. I remain calm and composed when faced with stressful or challenging situations.

1 2 3 4 5

7. I recognize when my biases or assumptions may influence my decisions.

1 2 3 4 5

8. I am comfortable admitting when I make mistakes and take responsibility for them.

1 2 3 4 5

9. I actively listen to others' perspectives, even when they differ from my own.

1 2 3 4 5

10. I understand how my leadership style impacts the performance and morale of my team.

1 2 3 4 5

11. I can identify my emotional triggers and manage them effectively.

1 2 3 4 5

12. I set aside time regularly to reflect on my personal and professional growth.

1 2 3 4 5

13. I feel confident in my abilities while being open to learning and improvement.

1 2 3 4 5

14. I am aware of how my words and actions affect the people I lead.

1 2 3 4 5

15. I remain authentic in my leadership, even when under pressure.

1 2 3 4 5

16. I prioritize understanding my team members' needs and perspectives.

1 2 3 4 5

17. I have a clear understanding of my values and how they guide my decisions.

1 2 3 4 5

18. I am proactive in addressing challenges or conflicts within my team.

1 2 3 4 5

19. I celebrate my successes while remaining humble and grounded.

1 2 3 4 5

20. I actively work on overcoming self-doubt or imposter syndrome.

1 2 3 4 5

Scoring: Calculate your total score by adding up the ratings for each statement. A higher score indicates stronger time management skills and habits.

Total Score: _____

Interpretation:

- **Level 1: Emerging Self-Awareness (Below 20 points)**
  Your journey toward self-awareness is just beginning, and this is a great opportunity to build the foundation of your leadership growth. Developing self-awareness involves regularly reflecting on your decisions, understanding how emotions impact behavior, and seeking input from others. Start by setting aside time for self-reflection, journaling about your leadership experiences, and requesting feedback from trusted colleagues or mentors. Building awareness will empower you to make better decisions and strengthen your connection with your team.
- **Level 2: Building Awareness Foundations (20-39 points)**
  You are beginning to understand the importance of self-awareness, but there's still significant room for growth. Focus on identifying areas where your biases or emotional triggers might affect your decision-making. Make it a habit to reflect on your strengths and weaknesses and how they impact your leadership. By committing to growth through intentional reflection, emotional regulation, and consistent feedback from others, you'll create a solid foundation for more impactful leadership.
- **Level 3: Growing into Self-Aware Leadership (40-59 points)**
  You are developing solid self-awareness, with a clear understanding of your leadership strengths and areas for improvement. At this stage, deepening your awareness of how your leadership style influences others will amplify your effectiveness. Consider working on recognizing how your words and actions affect your team and actively practicing emotional intelligence in challenging situations. Strengthening your ability to reflect on feedback and adjust your approach will help you lead with greater authenticity and impact.
- **Level 4: Mastering the Art of Self-Awareness (60-79 points)**
  You have strong self-awareness and are consistently intentional about your growth as a leader. You likely have a solid understanding of your strengths, weaknesses, and emotional triggers, and you use this knowledge to lead effectively. To reach the next level, focus on mentoring others to build their self-awareness and refine your ability to adapt in dynamic situations. Leaders at this stage should also seek opportunities to model self-reflection and emotional intelligence within their organizations, creating a culture of accountability and growth.
- **Level 5: Transformational Self-Awareness Leader (80-100 points)**
  You demonstrate exceptional self-awareness, consistently reflecting on your leadership and the impact you have on others. Your ability to understand and manage your emotions, strengths, and weaknesses makes you a role model for others. Leverage this skill by mentoring emerging leaders and helping them build their own self-awareness. At this level, focus on scaling your impact by fostering a culture of emotional intelligence and self-reflection within your organization, creating a legacy of transformational leadership.

Leadership Scenarios with Detailed Role Cards

Scenario #1: The Disconnected Team Meeting

Overview:
As a leader, you've called a meeting to address a critical project that is behind schedule. During the meeting, you focus on assigning tasks and setting deadlines, but several team members seem disengaged or hesitant to contribute. By the end of the meeting, you feel frustrated because it appears that the team isn't aligned or motivated to meet the new deadlines.

Role Cards for Scenario 1: (*Space Provided to Cut Out & Present to Participants*)

- **The Leader**
  - You are the leader responsible for this project. You feel the pressure to deliver results on time and are frustrated that the team isn't performing as expected.
  - Your focus in the meeting was efficiency—assigning tasks and clarifying deadlines. You may not have noticed that some team members were disengaged or didn't fully understand their roles.
  - Your goal is to figure out why the team isn't responding as expected and how you can improve their engagement and performance moving forward.

- **A Direct Report (Team Member)**
  - You are a team member who feels overwhelmed by the project's complexity. During the meeting, you didn't feel comfortable speaking up because you weren't sure how to express your concerns without seeming unprepared.
  - You feel like your contributions to the project are undervalued, and the lack of open dialogue during meetings makes it hard to share ideas.
  - Your perspective is that you want clearer communication and a sense that your input is appreciated.

- **A Peer or Collaborator**
  - You are another leader or collaborator who works with the team on a related project. During the meeting, you noticed the team's lack of enthusiasm and felt that the leader missed an opportunity to engage and energize the group.
  - You believe that the meeting would have been more effective if the leader had encouraged participation and acknowledged the team's challenges.
  - Your perspective is that the leader needs to focus on fostering collaboration and addressing team morale.

- **A Senior Leader or Stakeholder**
  - You are an executive or stakeholder monitoring the project's progress. You weren't present at the meeting, but you've heard about the team's struggles and have growing concerns about whether the leader is managing the team effectively.
  - Your perspective is that results are the priority, but you also recognize the importance of team engagement and morale in achieving those results.
  - You want to see the leader take proactive steps to address team dynamics and improve communication.

- **A Customer or Client**
  - You are an external client waiting on the project's completion. You've received updates about delays, which are impacting your own timelines and causing frustration.
  - You weren't at the meeting, but you sense that there may be issues with team alignment or leadership.
  - Your perspective is that you expect the leader to take accountability and ensure the project gets back on track without compromising quality.

Scenario #2: The Overlooked Contribution

Overview:
As a leader, you recently recognized a high-performing team member for their exceptional contributions during a team meeting. While you intended to inspire the group, other team members felt excluded or undervalued because their contributions were not acknowledged. Tensions have quietly risen, and productivity seems to have dipped.

Role Cards for Scenario 2: (*Space Provided to Cut Out & Present to Participants*)

- **The Leader**
  - You are the leader who praised one team member to motivate the group. You didn't realize that other team members might feel overlooked or unappreciated.
  - Your intention was to highlight a success story to encourage similar performance from others. You now sense that something is off in team dynamics and need to address it.
  - Your goal is to reflect on how to balance individual recognition with team-wide acknowledgment moving forward.

- **A Direct Report (The Recognized Team Member)**
  - You are the team member who was publicly recognized. While you appreciate the praise, you also feel a bit uncomfortable because it seems to have created tension with your colleagues.
  - You've noticed that some team members have been less collaborative since the recognition, and you're worried about being perceived as the "favorite."
  - Your perspective is that recognition is important, but it should be handled in a way that doesn't disrupt team cohesion.

- **A Peer or Collaborator**
  - You are a colleague who works closely with the team. You've observed the growing tension among team members and believe the recognition of one person inadvertently left others feeling excluded.
  - You think the leader's intentions were good but feel they missed an opportunity to celebrate the team as a whole.
  - Your perspective is that the leader should focus on recognizing collective efforts and ensuring everyone feels valued.

- **A Senior Leader or Stakeholder**
  - You are an executive monitoring the team's progress. You've received feedback that the team's productivity has declined, and you suspect that morale issues may be the root cause.
  - Your perspective is that the leader needs to address the situation quickly to avoid further disruption. You value recognition but believe it should be done in a way that motivates the entire team.
  - You expect the leader to develop strategies to maintain morale while driving results.

- **A Customer or Client**
  - You are a client who relies on the team's output for your own success. While you don't have direct insight into internal dynamics, you've noticed that recent deliverables have lacked the usual quality or timeliness.
  - Your perspective is that the leader should focus on maintaining a high-performing team and ensuring that internal challenges don't affect the end product.
  - You want reassurance that the leader is managing the team effectively and that any disruptions will be resolved.